Asia.[106] The prime minister approvingly mentioned Eisenhower's NATO speech in December, which stressed the "possibility of peaceful triumph," even likening some of the remarks to Buddha's words. Privately, he favorably compared the rhetoric emanating from that conference to the rhetoric emerging from a gathering of communist parties in Moscow.[107]

Nehru was sensitive about appearing to moderate or change India's foreign policy because of the US.[108] Privately, however, he and others weighed the potential impact of Indian actions and words on American attitudes. Thus Nehru instructed the Indian representative in the International Control Commission for Indochina not to condemn American-British-French proposals lest it cause a "definite breach with these Governments." He also stalled a minister advocating for more Soviet projects, noting that India needed to be cautious so as not to complicate Krishnamachari's efforts.[109] And when Krishna Menon made some harsh statements at the UN about a US-UK proposal on Kashmir, Nehru warned against "attacks on motives of sponsors" since India had to consider its interests outside the UN.[110] He also told parliament he "regretted very much" Krishna Menon's remarks.[111]

There was also more caution about appearing as "a crusader on the world stage." Denying a move away from nonalignment stemming from India's need for aid, Nehru asked Krishna Menon, who was heading India's UN General Assembly delegation, not to get "entangled in foreign matters."[112] Dutt sent out similar instructions to other diplomats.[113] The link between international security and India's parochial concerns meant Delhi could not help but get involved sometimes. But Nehru told parliament India should avoid unhelpful criticism and indiscriminate involvement.[114] Moreover, "we must put our own house in order first before we try to advise others."[115]

The Glorious Gamble

In the US, meanwhile, momentum for helping India was building. Two interagency groups had been created to assess Indian requirements and US options. In fall 1957, they indicated that the steps under consideration were insufficient. From Delhi, Bunker made the case for India as a "good long-term investment" for the US government and private sector.[116]

Dulles publicly noted that the US would give—within budgetary constraints—"sympathetic consideration" to any Indian aid request.[117]